



First one on one with a new employee: 16 questions to ask, by purpose (2026)

Last checked 5 October 2026. Fill in the [BRACKETS] with your own facts.

What motivates them

Which part of your work do you enjoy most?

What would you like to do more of?

What makes a good day here?

Learning and support

Is there any training that would help you now?

What do you wish someone had shown you when you started?

Feedback for you

What is one thing I could do differently to help you?

How do you like to get feedback: in the moment, in writing, or here?

Was I clear when I explained [TOPIC]?

First week

Settling in

What has been clear so far, and what has not?

Settling in

Who have you met, and who do you still need to meet?

Settling in

What would have helped you on your first day?

Settling in

Do you have everything you need to do your work: tools, access, a desk?

First month

Expectations

What do you think I expect from you in the next month? Let me tell you if that is right.

Expectations

What does a good first month look like to you?

Working together

How would you like me to give you feedback and how often?

Working together

What is the best way to reach you if I need something urgently?

<https://proskillpacks.github.io/managers/first-one-on-one-with-a-new-employee/>

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